



Plant focus: sedums

Fleshy-stemmed sedums make beautiful rock, roof, and container garden plants, while taller species are perfect for borders.

SEDUMS ARE TOUGH, DROUGHT-RESISTANT SUCCULENTS that have a range of uses in the garden. Taller forms are perfect for gravel gardens or sunny borders, while hardy low-growing species suit life up on the roof, forming a dense insulating carpet of foliage that can tolerate sun, wind, and subzero temperatures. Mat-forming sedums can also be used in rock gardens, cracks in walls and paving, or in troughs filled with gritty compost. The fleshy foliage, variegated or purple in some cultivars, is highly decorative, as are the heads of star-shaped flowers, which appear from midsummer to fall. Forms of *S. spectabile* and other large named cultivars are also valued for their ornamental seedheads, which persist through winter. Sedums thrive in full sun, although some will tolerate light shade, and are happiest in free-draining sandy soil—the stems will rot in wet conditions. Divide the larger forms every few years to stop the stems from flopping, leaving an unsightly gap in the center of the clump.

USING SEDUMS

Try the tallest forms of sedum in beds and borders. The dark, fleshy foliage of *S. telephium* cultivars creates an exciting contrast with variegated and green linear-leaved plants in a border, while the flat-topped flowers of *S. AUTUMN JOY*, add color to late-season displays and are followed by graphic seedheads.



The leafy *S. reflexum* and the tender, white-flowered *S. sedoides* make perfect partners for other succulents in a container.

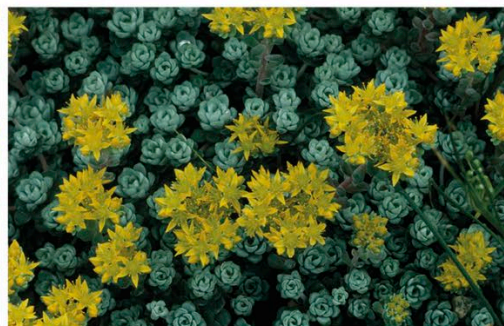
Sedums are practical plants for roofs, requiring the thinnest layer of soil, little fertilizer, and no irrigation once established.



POPULAR SEDUM SPECIES



Sedum acre Golden moss is an evergreen perennial that forms a dense mat of fleshy green or variegated foliage and star-shaped yellow flowers in summer or fall.



Sedum spathulifolium A low-growing evergreen perennial; most of its cultivars have silver or purple foliage and contrasting yellow summer flowers. It is effective in pots.



Sedum reflexum (syn. *S. rupestre*) This low-growing plant has spreading stems of blue-gray needlelike foliage that resembles conifer leaves, and yellow summer flowers.